

The Day the Tablet Slept

A PLAY BEFORE PIXELS READ-ALoud



The Day the Tablet Slept

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The illustrations are flat digital art. The text is set in Fredoka, with Bricolage Grotesque and Nunito Sans.

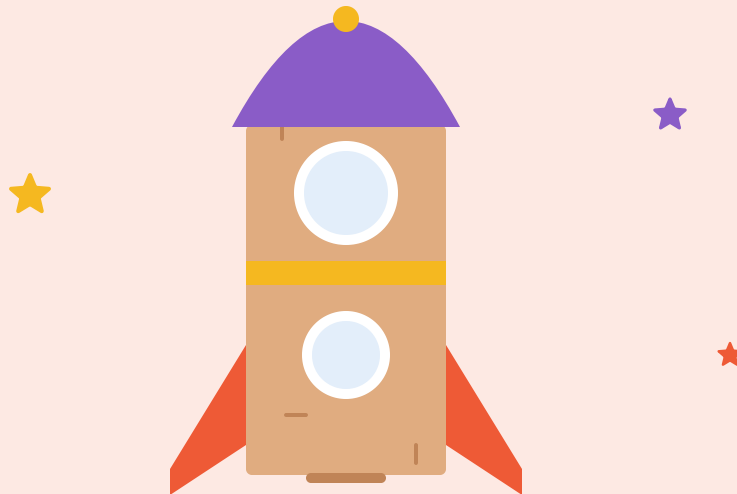
A note for grown-ups: puddle play, cooking and box-building are best enjoyed with a grown-up close by. Grown-ups handle the stove, and everyone washes hands after cracking eggs. The tablet in this story is a made-up character and is not based on any real product.

Free Play Day planner for grown-ups to print:
playbeforepixels.com/bonus/picture-tablet-slept

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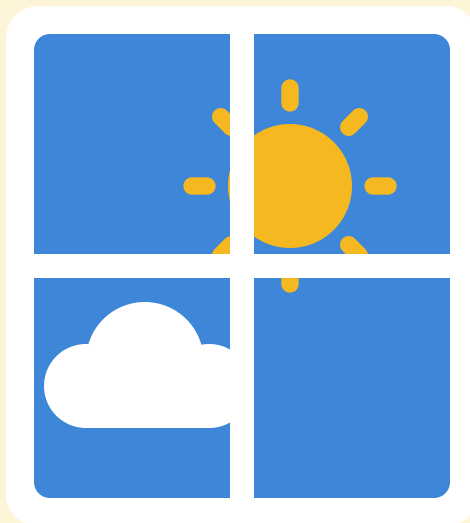
For every grown-up
who has ever said,
“Okay. One more story.”



On Saturday morning,
Ada zoomed downstairs.
Her slippers were on
the wrong feet.
She didn't care one bit.

GROWN-UP TIP

Point to Ada's slippers and wait. Let your child spot the silly part first.



But the tablet was wearing a nightcap.
Its eyes were shut tight.
And it was going...

zzz-bip... zzz-bip...



“Shhh,” whispered Papa.
“The tablet is sleeping.
Today, it gets a day off.”

GROWN-UP TIP

Whisper the “Shhh...” line, then pause before “do?” and let your child finish it.



“A nap?” said Ada. “In the MORNING?”
“Even tablets get sleepy,” said Papa.

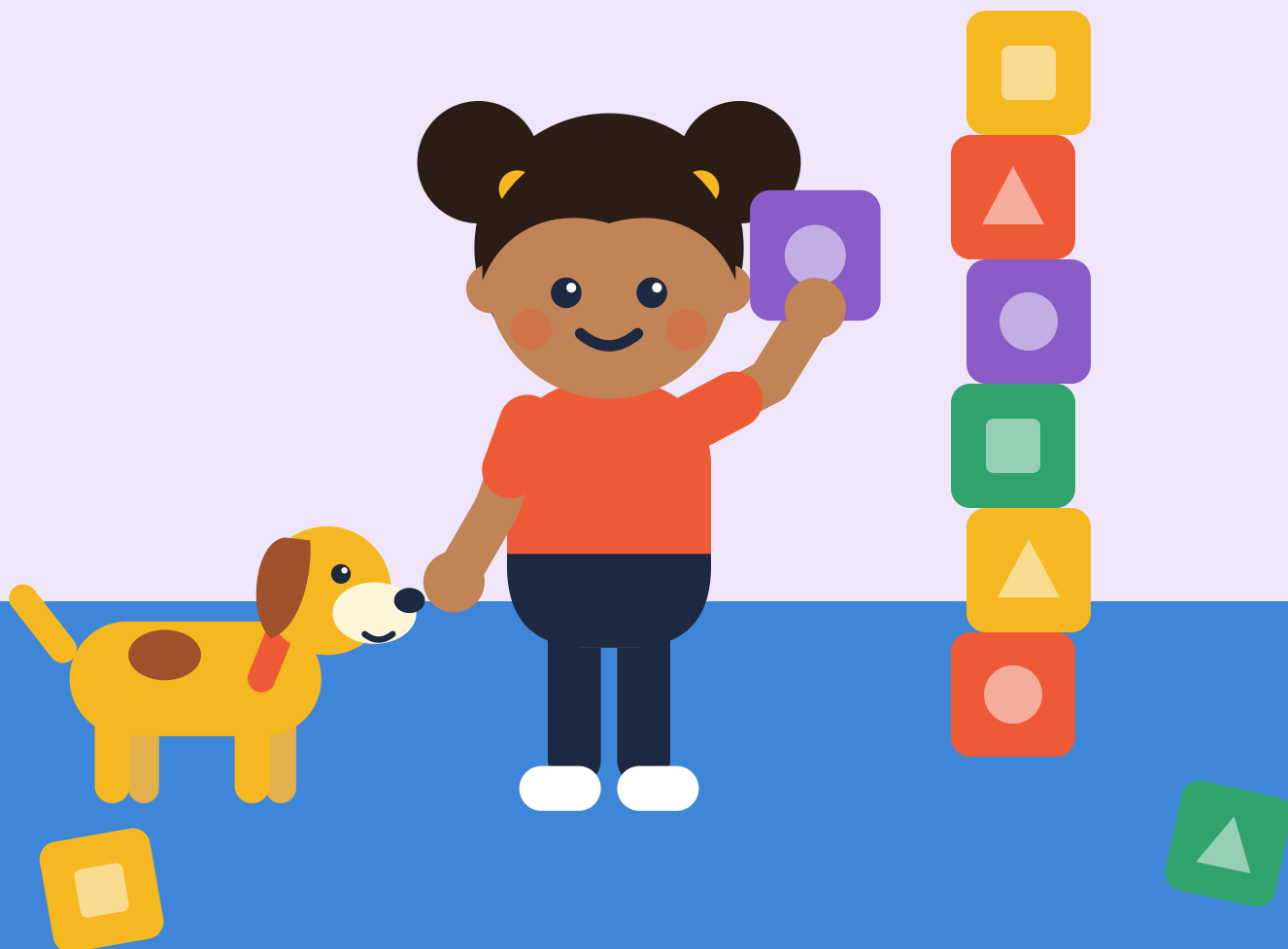
Shhh... the tablet is sleeping.
So what shall we do?



Ada found the blocks.
One, two, three... a tower!
Four, five, six... taller than Tater!
Tater held very, very still.

GROWN-UP TIP

Count the blocks together, then wait before “CRASH!”
Any sound counts as a turn.



Seven... eight... **CRASH!**

Tater said, **WOOF!**

Ada said, "AGAIN!"

So they built it again. And again. And AGAIN.



Outside: puddles!
One with a duck in it!
On went the yellow boots.



GROWN-UP TIP

Say what you see: “Big splash!” Then point, wait, and let your child name the next one.

SPLISH! went the small one.

SPLASH! went the middle one.

SPLOOOSH! went the big one...

all over Papa.

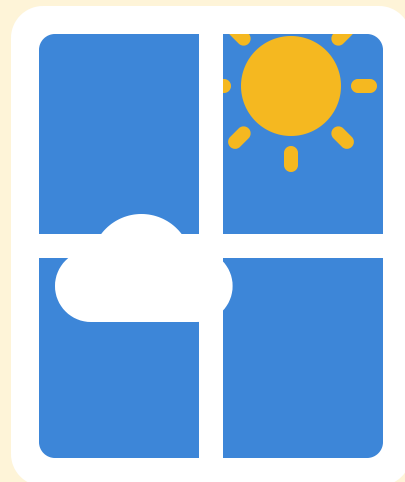
Papa laughed. And he jumped in too!



Back inside, Ada peeled off
her wet boots and tiptoed
to the shelf.
Tip... tip... tip...

GROWN-UP TIP

Tiptoe two fingers across the page. Going slow and quiet is a game too.



The tablet was still asleep.
It snored a teeny-tiny snore:
zzz-bip... zzz-bip...

Shhh... the tablet is sleeping.
So what shall we do?



A big, empty box!
“That’s not a box,” said Ada.
“That’s a **ROCKET!**”

GROWN-UP TIP

Ask, “What could a box be?” and wait. A word, a sign or a point is a great answer.



She gave it windows.

She gave it wings.

She gave it a purple top,
just like the tablet's nightcap.

WOOF! said Tater. (That means “Me too!”)



“Ten, nine, eight...” counted Ada.
Tater held on tight.
“...three, two, ONE!”

WHOOOOOSH!

GROWN-UP TIP

Count down together, slowly: “Ten, nine...” Then blast off, arms up high.



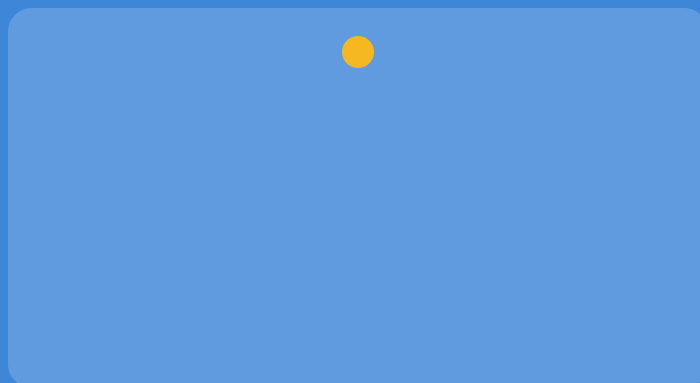
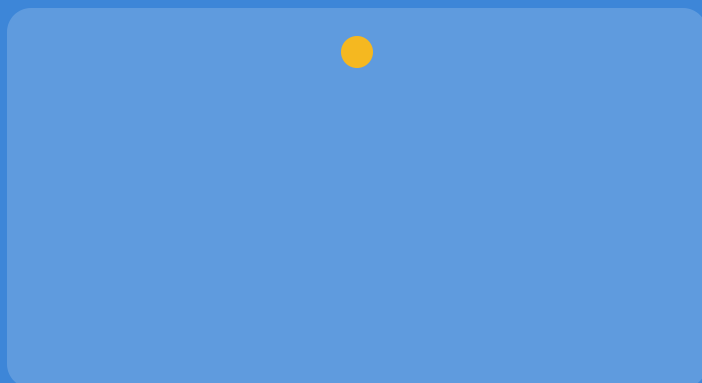
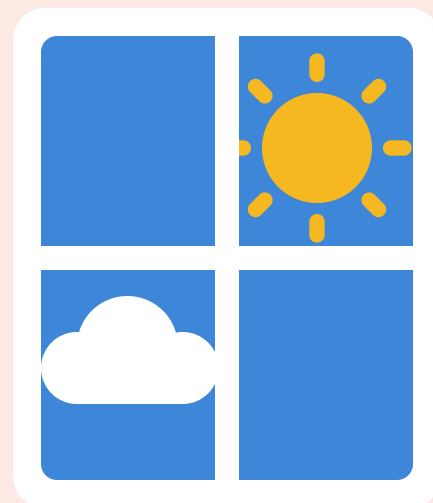
Past the moon. Past the stars.
Past a planet made entirely of socks.
Tater was the co-pilot.
He was very good at barking at comets.



Back on Earth,
Ada's tummy rumbled like a rocket.
"Pancakes?" asked Papa.
"**PANCAKES!**" said Ada.

GROWN-UP TIP

Offer a choice: "Pancakes or eggs?" Hold up two hands and let your child pick one.

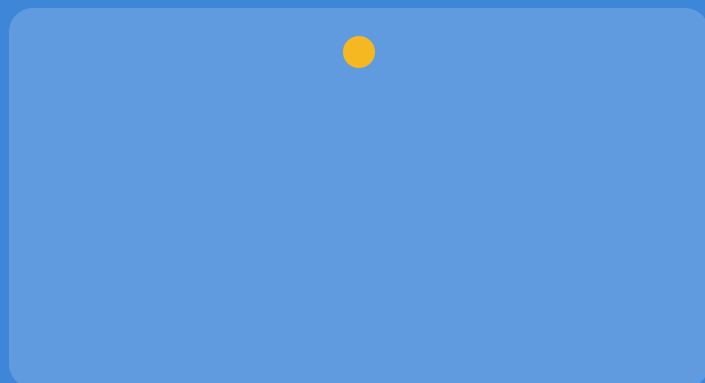
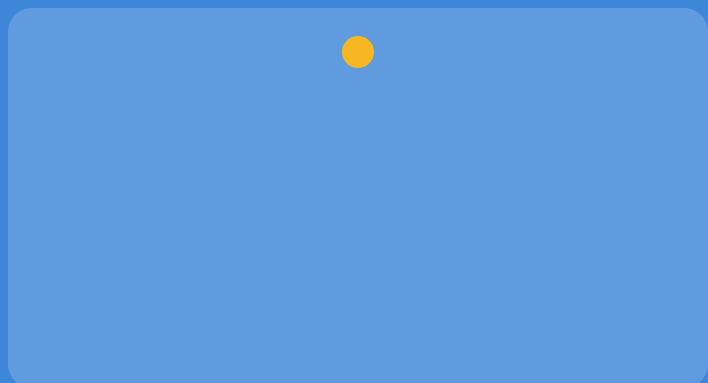


Ada cracked the egg (mostly into the bowl).

She stirred and stirred. Papa flipped.

Flip! Flop! Plop!

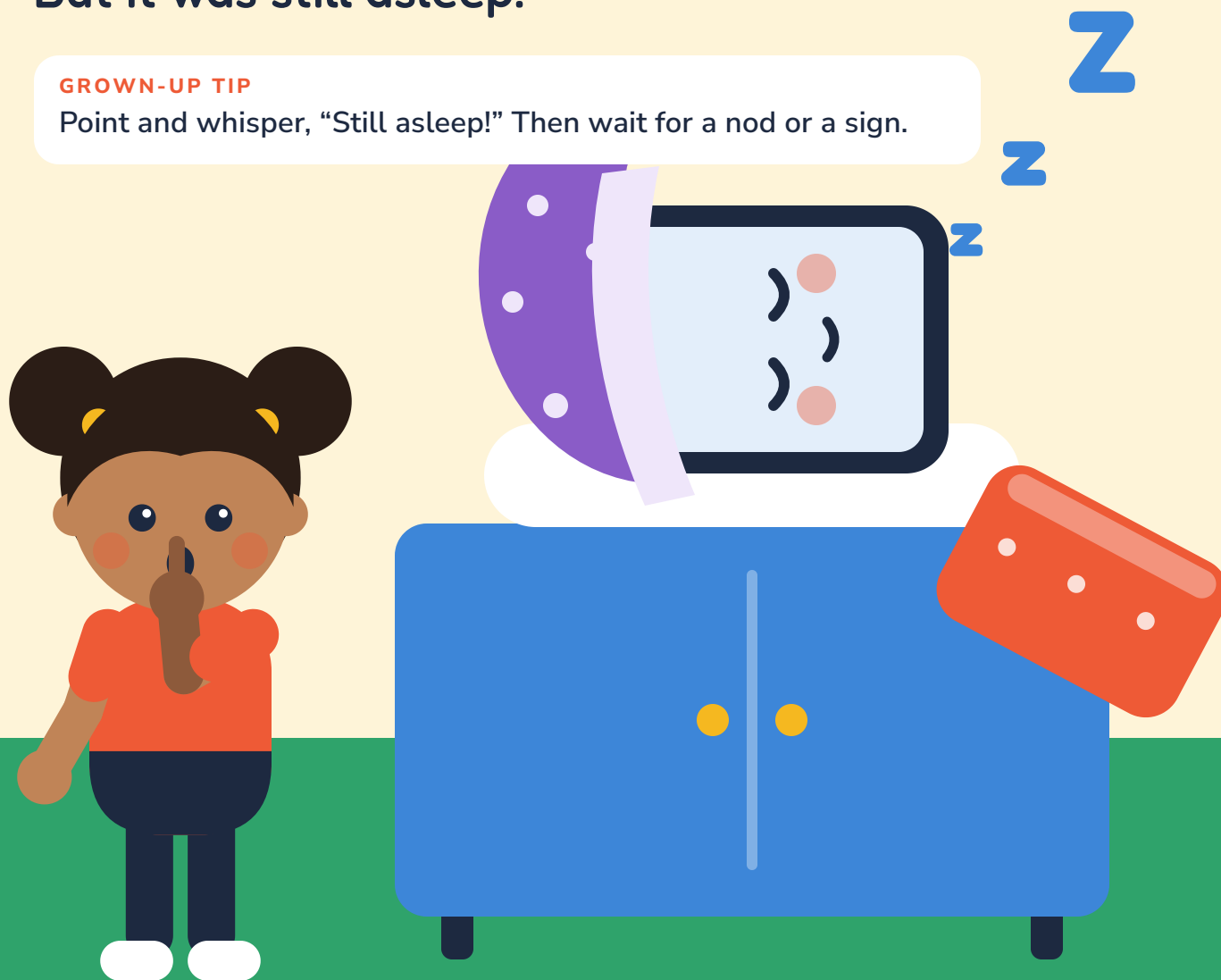
“That one looks like the moon,” said Ada.



After pancakes, Ada peeked at the shelf.
The tablet had rolled over.
Its nightcap had flopped.
But it was still asleep.

GROWN-UP TIP

Point and whisper, "Still asleep!" Then wait for a nod or a sign.



Shhh... the tablet is sleeping.
So what shall we do?

“Let’s go find some stories,” said Papa.



The library had books about dinosaurs,
books about rockets,
and one about a dog in a raincoat.

GROWN-UP TIP

Name two books you see, then
leave a gap. Let your child add the
next one.



“Welcome!” said Ms. Rosa the librarian.
“Sleepy stories live here.”
“Just like the tablet!” whispered Ada.
She picked a book about a growly bear.



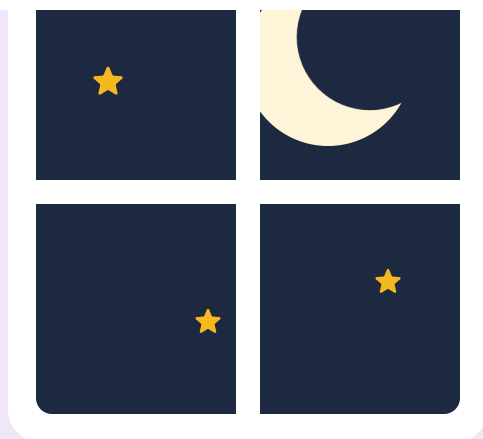
That night, Papa read the bear book.

Ada did the growly voices.

GRRR... GRRR... YAWWWN.

GROWN-UP TIP

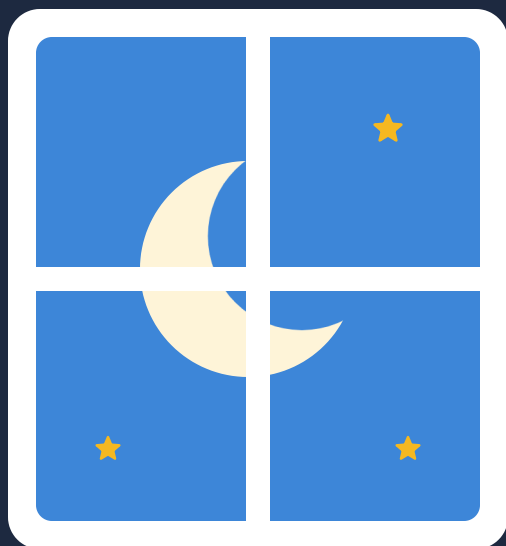
Take turns with the growly voice: you growl, then your child. Soft growls count.



“Best part of today?” asked Papa.
“The crash. The splash. The rocket.
The pancakes. The library...”
Ada yawned a big bear yawn.
“All of it.”



Down the hall, in its cozy nightcap,
the tablet slept on,
dreaming a quiet, happy dream.

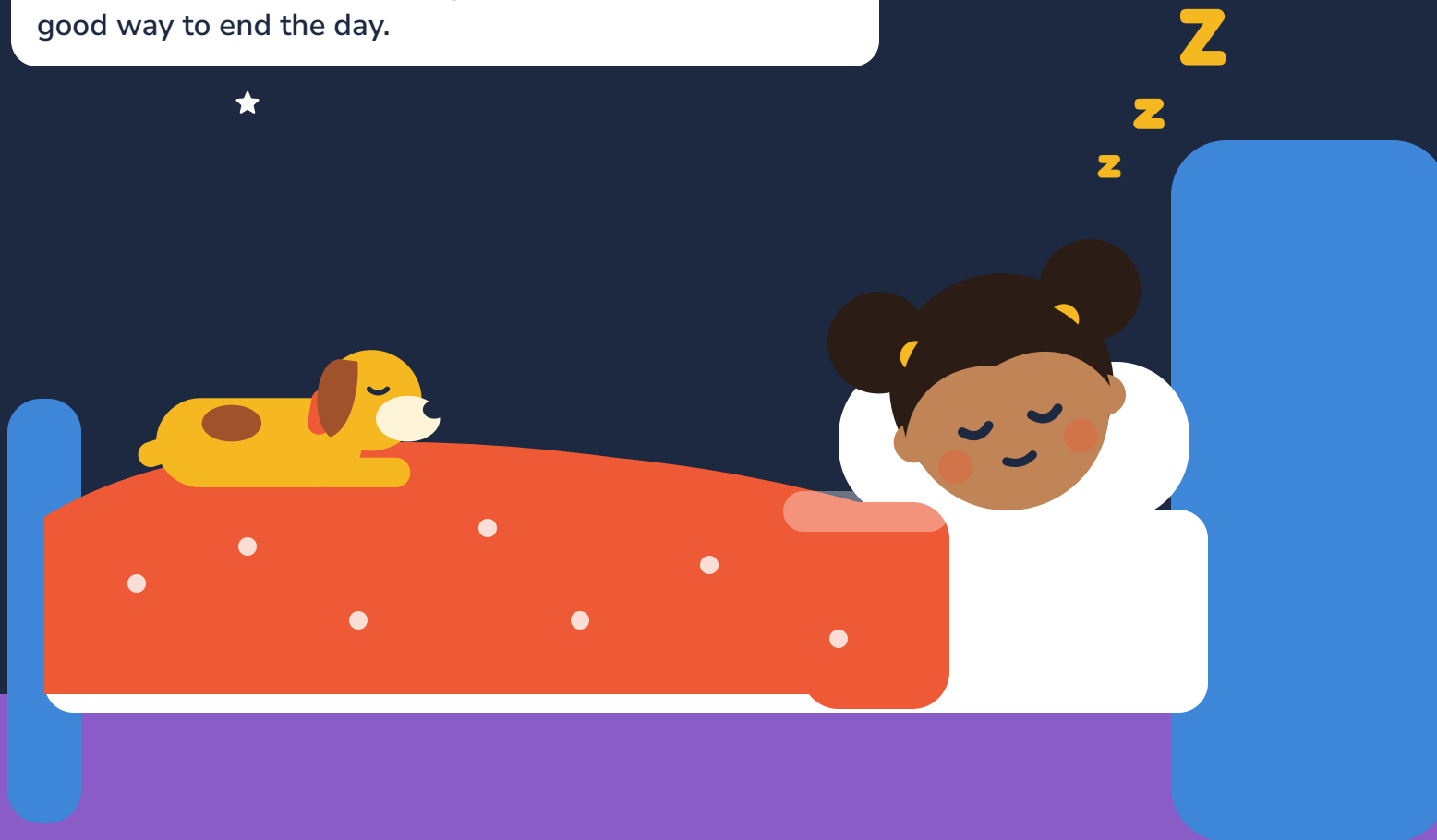


And snug in her bed,
with Tater at her feet,
Ada slept too.

**Shhh... everybody is sleeping.
What a day. What a PLAY day.**

GROWN-UP TIP

Whisper the last two lines together. Slow and soft is a good way to end the day.



In the morning, the tablet woke up and stretched.

“Good morning!” said Ada.

“Wait till I tell you about my day...”

Tater said, **WOOF!**



The End

Talk about it

For grown-ups: after reading, try a few of these. Pause, wait, and let your child answer. There are no wrong answers.



- 1 If you had a whole day off, what would you do first?
- 2 Crash, splash, rocket, pancakes, library... which part would you do again?
- 3 What could a big box turn into at our house?
- 4 Let's say the sleepy part together: "Shhh..." Now you be Tater!
- 5 If we cooked together, what would you like to make?
- 6 Blast off slowly: crouch for "Ten, nine...", then stretch up tall on "ONE!"

Read it again, and... pause before "do?" and let your child fill it in. Say what you see ("Tater is jumping!"), repeat and add one word ("Splash!" becomes "Big splash!"), and follow your child's lead. Shout, whisper, sign or point along to the "Shhh..." and the "WOOF!" A sign, a point or a tap on a talker (a device a child uses to talk) counts too, and a talker never takes a day off. **Talk, sing and read in the language you know best. Every language counts.**



Plan your own Play Day

Point to one thing for each part of the day. Then do it together!



Morning

Block tower · Puddle walk · Box rocket



Afternoon

Bake together · Library trip · Dance party



Bedtime story

Growly bear voices · Your favorite book · Make one up



Free for grown-ups: a printable Play Day planner to fill in, plus coloring pages. Scan the code or visit

playbeforepixels.com/bonus/picture-tablet-slept

Want more ideas? This story pairs with *100 Screen-Free Plays*.

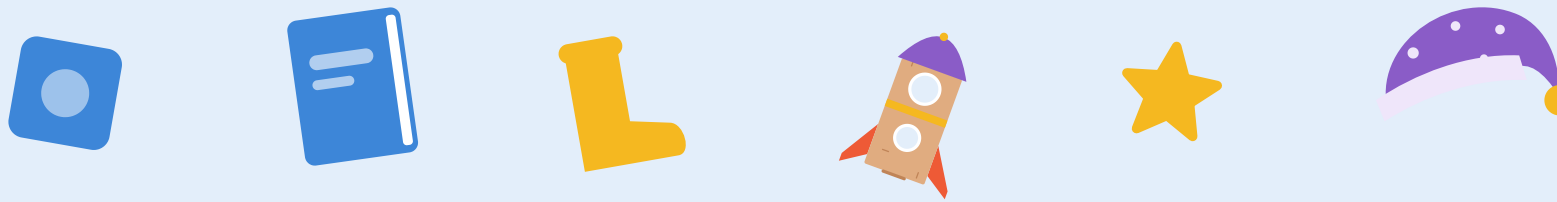
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